The chain of transformation of energy from one group of organisms to another, through various trophic levels is called **a food chain**. A system of interlocking and interdependent food chains is called a **food web**.

5.2 Biodiversity

Biodiversity or biological diversity refers to a wide variety of living organisms (plants, animals and other micro organisms) which live in a habitat. It is highly influenced by topography, climate as well as human activities. It represents the strength of the biological resources of a place on earth. In biodiversity, each species, no matter how big or small, has an important role to play in the ecosystem. It maintains the ecological balance and facilitates social benefits such as tourism, education, research etc. over an area.

5.2.1 Loss of biodiversity

The extinction of species (flora and fauna) due to human and natural influences is called **loss of biodiversity**.

A healthy eco system provides clean water, pure water, enriched soil, food, raw materials, medicines etc. Hence stable biosphere has to be conserved.

5.3 Biomes

A biome is a geographically extensive ecosystem where all flora and fauna are found collectively. It is the total assemblage of plant and animal life interacting within the biosphere. Biomes are defined by abiotic factors like, relief, climate, soils and vegetation. They are classified into two broad categories, **terrestrial biomes** and **aquatic biomes**.



- An ecological region that has lost more than 70% of its original habitat is considered a ***hotspot.***
- Hotspots in India are the Himalayas, Western Ghats, Indo Burma Region and Sundaland.
- There are 34 areas around the world which are qualified as biodiversity ***hotspots***

5.3.1 Terrestrial Biomes

Terrestrial biomes is a group of living organisms that live and interact with one another on land. They are mainly determined by temperature and rainfall. Some of the major terrestrial biomes of the world are

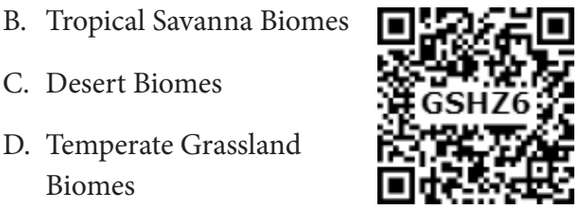
A. Tropical Forest Biomes

B. Tropical Savanna Biomes

C. Desert Biomes

D. Temperate Grassland Biomes

E. Tundra Biomes



A. Tropical Forest Biomes

The tropical forest biome is comprised of several sub-biomes, including evergreen rainforest, seasonal deciduous forest etc.

Tropical forests have the highest biodiversity and primary productivity of any of the terrestrial biomes. The **Amazon basin, Congo basin** and **Indonesian islands** are the major regions of this biome. These regions have very dense forests and so have great economic importance. Human

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